INCH-POUND

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MILITARY SPECIFICATION

POTATO SALAD, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers potato salad thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8940

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MILITARY

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit; Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For
MIL-C-44340 - Can, Tray Pack

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of Federal and Military specification, standards, and handbooks are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, (ATTN: NPODS), 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

United States Standards for Grades of Canned Pimientos

United States Standards for Grades of Sweet Peppers for Processing

(Copies are available from the Director, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2077, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

Regulations Governing the Inspection of Eggs and Egg Products (7 CFR Part 59)

(Copies are available from the Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 3932, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

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U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Copies are available from the Chairman, Condition of Food Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 0608, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

2.2 Non-government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 650 California Street, Suite 800, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3330 - Peel Adhesion of Pressure-sensitive Tape

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

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ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCE

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-flavors, off-odors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Potatoes, fresh. The potatoes shall be fresh, firm, and of a white flesh variety suitable for canning. The maximum specific gravity for the potatoes shall be 1.075, with a reducing sugar content of not more than 2.0 percent on a dry weight basis.

3.2.2 Dressing, salad. The salad dressing shall conform to the Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, Standard of Identity for Salad Dressing. The salad dressing shall be an emulsified semi-solid of smooth uniform consistency that is free from lumps, watery appearance and/or oil separation. The dressing shall possess a pleasing flavor and shall be a white to ivory (off-white) color.

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3.2.3 Celery, fresh. The celery shall be a fresh, crisp, white (blanched) or green variety. The celery shall be free from pithy branches, seed stems, and damage.

3.2.4 Egg yolks, liquid or frozen. Egg yolks may be liquid or frozen and shall have been processed in accordance with Regulations Governing the Inspection of Eggs and Egg Products (7 CFR Part 59), as evidenced by the USDA egg products inspection shield on the label. For liquid egg yolks, a USDA Egg Products Inspection Certificate shall indicate the date and time of pasteurization. Liquid egg yolks shall be held at a temperature of 40°F or lower and shall be held not more than 60 hours from time of pasteurization until the start of formulation of the product in which they are used. Frozen egg yolks shall be held at 10°F or lower and used within 120 days from the date of production. The egg yokes shall be free from off-odors, off-flavors, or foreign odor and flavors, such as sulfide-like, fruity, sour, or metallic, and shall be free from foreign materials.

3.2.5 Onions, dry, yellow. Dry yellow onions shall be sound, clear, firm, free from damage, and of the sweet Spanish or yellow globe types.

3.2.6 Relish, sweet pickle. Sweet pickle relish shall consist of cured, finely cut or finely chopped cucumbers packed in a vinegar solution with suitable nutritive sweetening ingredients. Sweet pickle relish may contain other finely cut or chopped vegetables such as cabbage, onions, and green and red peppers.

3.2.7 Oil, vegetable. The vegetable oil shall have a stability of 15 hours AOM (minimum), have a free fatty acid content not to exceed 0.05 percent by weight, have a moisture and volatile matter content not to exceed 0.1 percent by weight, and pass the Cold Test of 5.5 hours (minimum).

3.2.8 Peppers, green, sweet, fresh. Sweet green peppers shall be fresh, sound, and firm. The peppers shall be U.S. No. 1 of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Sweet Peppers.

3.2.9 Pimientos, canned. Pimientos shall be of the chopped style and shall be U.S. Grade C or better of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Pimientos.

3.2.10 Vinegar, cider. The cider vinegar shall be prepared from apple cider, be clear, light amber in color, and be free from haze, sediment, suspended matter, and floating particles. The cider vinegar shall contain not less than 4.0 percent and not more than 5.0 percent acetic acid.

3.2.11 Salt. Salt shall be non-iodized, white, refined sodium chloride, with or without anticaking agents and shall comply with purity standards for sodium chloride of the Food Chemicals Codex.

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3.2.12 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or outer and inner coverings have been removed. The ground white pepper shall have a characteristic penetrating odor, a hot biting pungent flavor, and a light color. The white pepper shall contain not less than 1.0 mL volatile oil per 100 grams and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.13 Garlic powder. Garlic powder shall be fancy grade in accordance with the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.14 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The preblended spice and seasoning mixture shall comply with the requirements of this specification. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.

3.2.15 Xanthan gum. Xanthan gum shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.16 Water. Water used for formulation, blanching, ice making and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.3 Preparation and processing.

3.3.1 Potato preparation. The fresh potatoes shall be washed, sorted, peeled, and trimmed. The potatoes shall be mechanically diced to approximately 1/2 by 1/2 by 1/2-inch dimensions, and the dices shall be cooked until tender. The cooked, diced potatoes shall be firm but not hard. The cooked potatoes shall be immediately cooled to the initial temperature of the cooling water and thoroughly drained. The cooled drained potatoes shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration and shall be filled into tray pack cans within 4 hours after cooking.

3.3.2 Celery preparation. The celery shall be cleaned thoroughly, trimmed to remove fibrous longitudinal strands, and cut transversely into approximately 1/8 to 3/8-inch slices. The celery slices shall be blanched sufficiently to prevent discoloration and to remove excess air. The blanched celery shall be immediately cooled and thoroughly drained. The cooled drained celery shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration and shall be filled into tray pack cans within 4 hours after blanching.

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3.3.3 Onion preparation. The onions shall be peeled, washed, cut into approximately 1/8 to 1/4-inch slices. The onions shall be blanched and handled as specified in 3.3.2.

3.3.4 Egg yolk preparation. Frozen egg yolks shall be tempered to a temperature not to exceed 40°F and held at 40°F or lower, and used within 24 hours after they have been tempered. The egg yolks shall be completely cooked to a firmness equivalent to a hard boiled texture. Cooling shall follow immediately after cooking to the extent that the egg yolks shall be free from any green discoloration prior to combining the yolks with the other potato salad ingredients. The cooked egg yolks shall be diced to 3/8 by 3/8 by 3/8 inch, and the dices shall be sized so that at least 75 percent are retained on a U.S. No. 7 sieve.

3.3.5 Green pepper preparation. The sweet green peppers shall be cored; thoroughly cleaned to remove seeds, dirt, and any extraneous material; and chopped into approximately 1/4 by 1/4-inch pieces. The sweet green peppers shall be blanched and handled as specified in 3.3.2.

3.3.6 Vegetable and egg yolk mixture preparation. The vegetables and egg yolks shall be combined as follows: 1/

Ingredients	Percent by weight
Potatoes, diced, cooked	70.22
Celery	8.95
Egg yolks, cooked	7.84
Onions	4.29
Relish	3.92
Sweet green peppers	2.45
Pimientos, drained	2.33

1/ The vegetable and egg yolk mixture shall be combined with the sauce immediately after preparation.

3.3.7 Sauce formulation. The sauce shall be formulated as follows:

Ingredients	Percent by weight
Salad dressing	67.41
Cider vinegar 1/	10.88
Vegetable oil	9.00
Water 1/	6.57
Salt 2/	5.44
White pepper	0.41
Xanthan gum	0.20
Garlic powder	0.09

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1/ The percentage of cider vinegar and water shall be adjusted appropriately to achieve the pH required in the finished product.

2/ The total amount of salt in the sauce formula shall be adjusted as necessary to yield a product that complies with the finished product salt requirements (see 3.6).

3.3.8 Potato salad preparation. The vegetable and egg yolk mixture and the sauce shall be combined in the following proportions.

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Vegetable and egg yolk mixture	80
Sauce	20

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with the product to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. The filling operation shall ensure a uniform mixture of product.

b. Each tray pack can shall be filled with potato salad to a total can content weight of 106 ounces.

c. Each can shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum established by a processing authority and specified in the scheduled process so as to assure compliance with the finished product requirement (see 3.6 1).

d. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within 2 hours after product preparation.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting at 200° to 220°F until a sterilization value of not less than F_{200}^{16} = 10 minutes has been achieved. The filled and sealed thermoprocessed tray pack cans shall show no evidence of can swelling when tested for commercial sterility as specified in 4.5.3.5.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insects, insect parts, hair, wood, paper, paint, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

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d. Product shall be a uniform distribution of off-white potato dices, naturally colored celery, green peppers, pimientos, onion, and light yellow egg yolk pieces in a thick off-white to pale yellow sauce.

e. Texture of vegetables shall not be mushy, hard, fibrous, or tough.

f. The average pH shall be not less than 4.15 nor greater than 4.45.

g. No individual pH value shall be less than 4.10 or greater than 4.50.

h. The average net weight shall be not less than 106 ounces.

i. No individual can shall contain less than 104 ounces of product.

j. The salt content of any individual can shall be not less than 1.0 percent or greater than 1.4 percent.

k. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

l. Filled, sealed, and retorted cans shall show evidence of proper vacuum as determined by concavity of the can lid (see 4.5.6).

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged in establishments meeting the requirements of Title 21, Code of Federal Regulations, Part 110, "Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Processing, Packaging or Holding of Human Foods," and the plant sanitation requirements of the appropriate Government inspection agency.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all the requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

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4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

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4.5.3.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.3.2 Product inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table I. The tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be opened and inspected for the defects listed in table II.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection 1/

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (cans)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 3,200	8	-	0	2
	8	16	1	2
3,201 to 35,000	13	-	0	3
	13	26	3	4

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and, if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

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TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Texture of vegetables is mushy, hard, fibrous, or tough
102	Individual components not uniformly distributed
103	Product shows evidence of excessive heating (is materially darkened or scorched)

1/ The presence of foreign material (for example; glass, dirt, insects, insect parts, hair, paper, paint, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example; burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, musty, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparision shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) agent.)

4.5.3.3 pH testing. Three tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot. Three aliquots shall be randomly drawn from each sample tray pack. The pH of each of the resulting nine aliquots shall be determined in accordance with Paragraph 32.017, Part 3 of the Vegetable Products, Processed Chapter of the 14th Edition (1984) of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.01. If the average of all nine determinations is less than 4.15 or greater than 4.45 or if any individual determination is less than 4.10 or greater than 4.50, the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.3.4 Salt content testing. Nine tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot and distributed as follows:

- Three for laboratory analyses.
- Three for submission to the contractor.
- Three for retention by an AMS agent as reserve samples.

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The three tray packs for laboratory analyses shall individually be tested for salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists. Preparation of the samples shall be as follows. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. If the salt content of any individual tray pack is less than 1.0 percent or more than 1.4 percent, it shall be classified as a major defect and the lot shall be rejected. Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original laboratory analysis indicated that the involved lot will be rejected because of noncompliance with the salt content requirement. When the reserve samples are analyzed, the analysis for salt shall be made and will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in subsequent lots.

4.5.3.5 Commerical sterility testing. The sample size shall be one filled, sealed, and thermoprocessed tray pack can selected from each retort batch in the lot. The sample cans shall be tested for sterility by incubating the cans at 95° ± 5°F for 10 days. Any evidence of can swelling shall be classified as a critical defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.4 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with 4.5.4.1. In addition, the following defect shall be classified as a critical defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot:

Evidence of buffing causing scratches or scuffing of exterior can coating.

4.5.4.1 Can label examination. Labels shall be examined for defects in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4), except, for self-adhering labels, the following additional defects shall apply:

Major: Label torn or scratched so as to obliterate any of the markings.

Minor: Air bubbles under label.
Label not properly adhered to can, for example, label raised or peeled back from edges or corners.

4.5.4.2 Label adhesive examination. When self-adhering labels are used, the adhesive shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 3330.

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4.5.5 Can closure examination. Can closure shall be examined visually and by teardowns in accordance with the can manufacturer's requirements and CFR 21, Part 113, Subpart D. Any nonconformance based on observation of can seam teardowns or on record of can seam teardowns shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of any involved product.

4.5.6 Vacuum examination. Cans shall be allowed to cool to 75° ± 5°F, held for at least 24 hours after sealing, and then examined for vacuum retention. To examine, lay a straight edge in the center of the lid along the length of the tray pack. Both ends of the straight edge shall touch the lid at the inside edge of the double seam. There shall be a visible gap between the straight edge and the lid for the entire distance of the label panel. Using a shorter straight edge, the same procedure shall be used across the width, in the center of the tray pack can. One measurement shall be made when examining a ribbed lid; lay the straight edge between the two center ribs along the length of the can. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in a single shift on a single sealing machine. The sample size shall be 50 cans. Any nonconformance shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.7 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape.
Dimensions of pads not as specified.
Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

4.5.8 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A.

5.1.1 Level A. One hundred and six ounces of food product shall be filled into a tray pack can conforming to MIL-C-44340 and sealed and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5. Buffing of the can causing damage to the exterior can coating is not permitted (see 4.5.4).

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5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L or HSC-L with a HSC full depth cover, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box. Each box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1) except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern so as to create columnar stacking. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1 except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

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5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 or 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified, except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load, with all courses having the same pattern so as to create columnar stacking. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and with the following:

- Official establishment number (for example; est 38) or a three letter code identifying the establishment.
- Lot number 1/
- Production shift number 1/
- Retort identification number 1/
- Retort cook number 1/

1/ The lot number shall be expressed as a four digit Julian code. The first digit shall indicate the year of production and the next three digits shall indicate the day of the year (Example, March 19, 1987, would be coded as 7078). The Julian code shall represent the day the product was packaged and processed. Sub-lotting (when used) shall be represented by an alpha character immediately following the four digit Julian code. Following the four-digit Julian code and the alpha character (when used), the other required code information shall be printed in the sequence as listed above.

In addition, the name of the product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined as specified in 4.5.4 after preparation of product in accordance with heating instructions. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

DO NOT HEAT

YIELD: Serves 18 portions of 2/3 cup each.

As an alternate labeling method, a preprinted, self-adhering, 0.002-inch thick, clear polyester label printed with indelible black ink may be used. Self-adhering labels shall be applied after retorting. Pressure-sensitive adhesive shall require no preparation prior to application. Labels shall tack quickly and adhere without curling or breaking. The adhesive shall have a minimum adhesion of 60 ounces per inch width when examined as specified in 4.5.4.2. When self-adhering labels are used, the tray pack can shall be labeled with the Julian code and a product code prior to retorting.

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5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary marking in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE, UNLESS PALLET RACKS ARE USED.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).
e. Level of packing required (see 5.2).
f. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

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6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Canned food
Combat field feeding
Food processing
Operational rations
Shelf stable

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing Activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8940-0665)

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC
DP - SS

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-S-44267A	Potato Salad, Thermostabilized, Tray Pack

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

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